



UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
OFFICE OF ELEMENTARY AND SECONDARY EDUCATION

June 30, 2022

The Honorable Heather Mueller
Commissioner of Education
Minnesota Department of Education
400 NE Stinson Blvd
Minneapolis, MN 55413

Dear Commissioner Mueller:

I am writing in response to Minnesota's request to the U.S. Department of Education (Department) on May 20, 2022, to amend its approved consolidated State plan under the Elementary and Secondary Education Act of 1965 (ESEA). Prior to implementing any revisions to its approved consolidated State plan, a State must submit its proposed amendments to the Department for review and approval.

I have determined that the amended request meets the requirements in the ESEA and, for this reason, I am approving Minnesota's amended State plan. A summary of Minnesota's amendment is enclosed. This letter, as well as Minnesota's revised ESEA consolidated State plan, will be posted on the Department's website. Any further requests to amend Minnesota's ESEA consolidated State plan must be submitted to the Department for review and approval. I understand that Minnesota intends to implement three new School Quality or Student Success indicators (i.e., 9th Grade Course Completion, College and Career Readiness Coursework, and Well-Rounded Education) next year. Minnesota must submit a request to the Department with sufficient detail, including how the indicators are calculated, how they meaningfully differentiate among all public schools in the State, and how they will be included in the system of annual meaningful differentiation, before they are included in the State's accountability system.

Please be aware that approval of this amendment to Minnesota's consolidated State plan is not a determination that all the information and data included in the amended State plan comply with Federal civil rights requirements, including Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act, and requirements under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act. It is Minnesota's responsibility to comply with these civil rights requirements.

Thank you for all of the work that the Minnesota Department of Education has put into its consolidated State plan under the ESEA. If you need any assistance regarding the implementation of your ESEA consolidated State plan, please contact the Office of School Support and Accountability at: OESE.Titlei-a@ed.gov.

Sincerely,

/s/

James F. Lane, Ed.D.
Senior Advisor, Office of the Secretary
Delegated the Authority to Perform the
Functions and Duties of the Assistant Secretary
Office of Elementary and Secondary Education

Enclosure

cc: Michael Diedrich, Minnesota Department of Education

Amendment to the Minnesota Consolidated State Plan

The following is a summary of Minnesota’s amendment request. Please refer to the Department’s website (<https://oese.ed.gov/offices/office-of-formula-grants/school-support-and-accountability/essa-consolidated-state-plans/>) for Minnesota’s complete consolidated State plan.

- *Subgroups*
Beginning in the 2022-2023 school year, Minnesota will define the “American Indian” subgroup to include only students who meet the Minnesota State definition of American Indian, consistent with Minnesota State law. Minnesota will also utilize an “Other Indigenous Peoples” subgroup to include students who are American Indian or Alaska Native, but do not Minnesota’s State definition. Minnesota will continue to identify all other major racial and ethnic subgroups.
- *Graduation Rate Long-Term Goals*
Minnesota revised the timeline of its graduation rate long-term goal from 2020 to 2025. The long-term goals of 90 percent for all students and 85 percent for each subgroup of students, including students who receive special education services, remains the same. Minnesota also added its State-defined goal to decrease the four-year high school dropout rate by 2.5 percent for all students, and to no more than 5 percent for each subgroup of students, including students who receive special education services.
- *Academic Achievement Indicator*
For accountability determinations in fall 2022 only, rather than use data from the most recent three years of data, Minnesota will calculate its Academic Achievement indicator using data from the 2018-2019 and 2021-2022 school years, with the 2018-2019 results being weighted twice compared to the 2021-2022 results.
- *Other Academic Indicator for Elementary and Secondary Schools that are Not High Schools*
For accountability determinations in fall 2022 only, rather than using growth calculations from the past three years, Minnesota will calculate its Other Academic indicator for elementary and secondary schools that are not high schools based on student growth data between the 2017-2018 to the 2018-2019 school years and between the 2020-2021 and 2021-2022 school years (i.e., Minnesota will implement its value table model and award points based on a student’s change in achievement levels between these school years). Minnesota will double the weight for data from the 2018-2019 school year as compared to the 2021-2022 school year.
- *School Quality or Student Success Indicator*
For the 2021-2022 school year only, Minnesota’s SQSS indicator will use a different calculation for the attendance measure. For this year, Minnesota will calculate a maintenance of enrollment indicator, which will compare the enrollment in the 2021-2022 school year to a three-year average of enrollment from the 2016-2017, 2017-2018, and 2019-2020 school years. Minnesota will also use two years of pre-pandemic data (i.e., from the 2018-2019 and 2019-2020 school years) to calculate consistent attendance.

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After 2021-2022 school year, Minnesota will return to using the three most recent school years to calculate its consistent attendance SQSS. After 2021-2022 school year, Minnesota will return to using the three most recent school years to calculate its consistent attendance SQSS indicator.

- *Annual Meaningful Differentiation*
For the 2021-2022 school year only, Minnesota is revising its stage-based system of annual meaningful differentiation. Specifically, Minnesota is revising the third stage of its process to include two years of prior consistent attendance data from before the COVID-19 pandemic and rank-ordering schools to identify those with the lowest consistent attendance data. From there, Minnesota is adding stage to rank all schools that proceeded from stage three by enrollment maintenance to identify the bottom 5 percent of schools for CSI.
- *Additional Statewide Categories of Schools*
Minnesota is adding “Category F” schools which will be identified beginning in fall 2022 and every three years. Category F schools are schools that contribute 30 percent or more of a credit or dropout recovery school’s population, where the credit or dropout recovery school has a 7-year graduation rate below 67 percent.